

Sunday, August 21

This is the last day at Waskesiu. Cheryl, Peter and I are spending our time feeling badly about it. After an early rise and shower (Peter insisted on having his second in two days) we ate breakfast and packed the car. I was with him in bed for fifteen minutes before he got up. He was full of questions about the courtship of wolves in *Death of a Legend*. We wanted to know about the things he had seen, driving at the point when he sensed evasiveness until he was satisfied his questions had been answered. He grinned, hunched his head into his shoulders and yucked several times. These questions continued in the shower and during breakfast, never being repeated, always plucking at some new facts. This is not an easy topic to talk about.

We were packed by 10. We paid the bill and drove to the lake. The sun was bright but the wind chopped up the lake and cooled the air. Our plan to sit on the beach until 5 would never be carried out. We had coffee and toast at the Park Centre Cafe, drove around Prospect Avenue and Orchid Street, stopped at the community ballpark when Matthew fell asleep and played baseball or read. We drove to the beachhouse for hamburgers, and finally decided to leave. The weather was not good enough for sunning. On the way out of the Park Peter and I went up the observation tower at the height of land where a German couple puzzled over a plaque, and then by the Buffalo Paddocks where cars had pulled over on both sides to see the 30-odd bison by the fence. We had been telling Peter the trip would take an hour. He was impatient with driving. He asked Cheryl to tell him when an hour was up.

Cheryl said, "Okay, we'll tell you when we get to the farm."

In a fairly sarcastic tone Peter replied, "I guess I know when we get to the farm. I want to know when an hour is up."

We arrived at the farm by 2, found Cheryl's parents at the Isaachsen's with the long trailer. After coffee I changed into work clothes and helped load the Inland granary on the trailer. Cheryl and her mother dug potatoes. By five-thirty we were on the road; we had the granary off in no time once we got there.

We ate supper (spaghetti, meatballs and farmer's sausage), changed and drove to Louise's where Judy, Dawn-Marie, Erling, Barb, Debbie, Erland, Ernest, Maggie and Tabatha were visiting. We left at 10. Peter was tired but talked. Matthew slept. We were in bed by 10:40.